

Desktop PCs

Lenovo is considered to listen and respond to customer feedback more intently than the rest

Digital Cameras

Sony tops the list in terms of aided recall, knowledge of sales people and quality of after sales service

Digital Cameras

Pointers for the shooters

For those of you who remember, last year, we were unable to separate Canon and Sony, with both brands winning our trust award. This year, Canon edges ahead of Sony by a whisker, to claim Digit's 2009 *Icon of Trust* Award, for digital cameras.

Samsung seems to have the biggest loss, falling four places to seventh spot. Olympus, surprisingly jumps three spots ahead to end up at fourth. Nikon continues its steady climb by going from fourth last year to third this time. But that's just the numbers, what does this all mean to us?

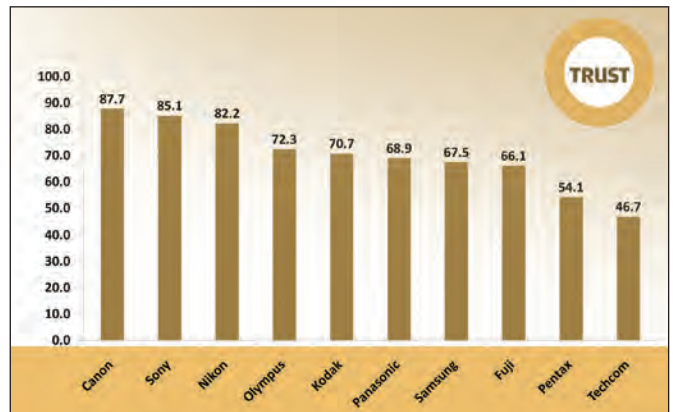
When it comes to top of mind, unaided recall, Canon was far ahead of the competition. Sony and Nikon were second and third, with almost equal top of mind recall amongst the respondents.

Overall, in terms of awareness, Canon was the ultimate winner here, with

excellent top of mind recall. Sony and Nikon are not far behind, but the rest of the pack is sorely lagging – looks like it's time to up those ad-expenditures.

Credibility was a much closer contest, again between Canon, Sony and Nikon. In every aspect of our questioning, it was really hard to tell these brands apart, with almost an equal number of respondents vouching for each of these three brands throughout. For innovativeness, however, Sony ruled, with more people feeling Sony trumped Canon. When it came to ease of use, also, Sony and Canon (in that order) were quite a bit ahead of the rest.

When it came to satisfaction, Sony edged out Canon by a fraction, with Nikon coming in third. Availability seems to be key here, with most people feeling that Sony cameras were more available in stores. The respondents felt that



I love my Canon because I can use pen torch cells and it has a great optical zoom. These are the two main reasons I bought this camera.

Govardhana Rao, Bengaluru

Canon was better than Sony at resolving queries, and faster at fixing problems – a nice area to win.

As for brand loyalty, digital camera owners who had bought a Canon seemed quite loyal to the brand, with more people vowing to buy Canon again. Even when it came to recommendations, most people said they would recommend either of the top three – Canon, Nikon or Sony.

When it comes to cost of ownership, Canon and Sony were the top two, indicating that they are sturdy, and people don't spend too much on them after purchase. However, Kodak jumped up to secure third place ahead of Nikon.

In terms of overall trust, the big three in the camera markets seem to be duelling it out, and leaving the rest far behind.

Monitors

The reign continues

Last year's survey revealed that Samsung and Dell were the top two monitor choices, and this year that remains unchanged. However, last year's third placed HP has slipped a massive three places to sixth this year. AOC is a new entrant, and debuts straight into fifth place – ahead of HP – impressive. The biggest fall was Lenovo, who fell 4 spots to a disappointing ninth. This is a closely fought category, with four brands battling for AOC's fifth place.

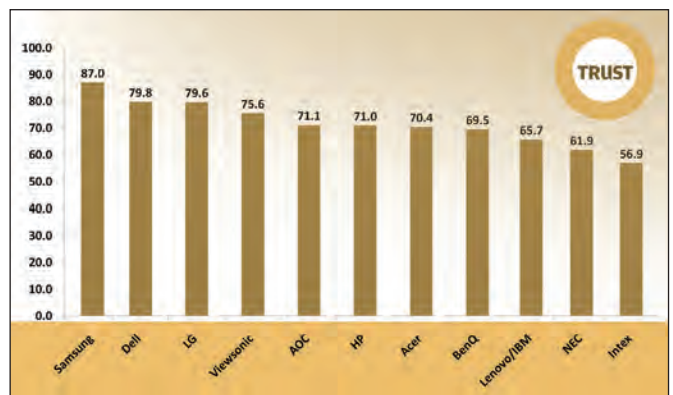
Samsung was miles ahead of all competition in the awareness field, and actually stood first in all five categories.

Consider this: half of all the respondents polled said "Samsung" when asked which monitor manufacturer first came to mind.

In terms of credibility, Samsung was just ahead of

Dell on almost every question – people did feel that Dell was just a tad more technologically advanced and had more innovative features. However, when it comes to quality, sturdiness, improvements, responsiveness to consumer needs, and style, Samsung won on all those counts.

When it came to satisfaction, LG displaced Dell in second place, indicating that lot of people were buying LG as well, and were quite satisfied with what they had. It's not surprising because both Samsung and LG scored much higher than Dell in terms of availability in stores. People also felt that Samsung, LG and Viewsonic were the brands that made information about their products available most easily, and educated their sales people the best. According to the respondents, the same three, in the same order, were the



The product quality of Dell is quite good. I have three monitors in total and the picture quality from the Dell is definitely the best.

Aditya Poddar, Pune

best at making desired models available for purchase across India.

Samsung and Dell users are also very loyal, and a vast majority of respondents wanted to recommend them in that order to their friends. The same held true when answering the question, "Would you buy this brand's monitors again?", as well as "Would you buy other products from this brand?". Apart from the big two, a lot of

the respondents were loyal to LG, Viewsonic, HP and AOC as well.

When it came to ownership costs (TCO), however, there was a deviation of perceptions. Although Samsung stood like a rock in first place, Dell fell behind LG, Viewsonic and BenQ, to fifth. This implies that people feel that Dell is a little more expensive to own and maintain than it should be.